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WE CONNECT YOUR BRAND TO TODAY'S CONNECTED CONSUMERS

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FANDUEL: REDDIT

M&C Saatchi Performance has been working with FanDuel since 2018. We run performance marketing across channels such as Apple Search Ads and in-app display for both the Sportsbook and Casino apps.

FanDuel offers online gambling on sportsbook, daily fantasy sports and online casino betting, and was founded as a daily fantasy sports provider. In 2018 legislation in the USA was somewhat relaxed, widening the number of states where online sports betting was legalized, as a result as of June 2023 FanDuel are now active in 13 states across the country.

The market is highly competitive, with both established brands and newcomers moving into the space. In addition the sector is highly seasonal, with the major leagues having peak periods throughout the year depending on the sport.

Additional materials:
Find out read more about the online sports betting market in the USA in our last report Online Sports Betting in the USA.

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CAMPAIGN BACKGROUND

The festive season is a particularly challenging period for online gambling companies. Market media rates tend to be higher during this season. This brief was specifically related to engaging NFL fans, as the season starts in September and gains momentum towards the Holiday period. Increased competition can make retaining campaign efficiency a challenge and is a key consideration for FanDuel. At the same time, competitors increase spend significantly due to the NFL popularity meaning screen time increases.

Our goal for FanDuel was to not just retain market share but continue to grow the business through acquiring new users at scale within a benchmark Cost Per Acquisition of $150. From previous campaign activity, the value of Reddit had been proven due to the nature of its highly engaged and passionate audiences and communities. Therefore, Reddit was selected as a key channel for running this campaign.

Through testing we found that mid-funnel/branding efforts are successful on Reddit, especially when we utilize different and engaging placements. Reddit is a hugely valuable platform for FanDuel, with highly engaged and relevant audiences. FanDuel's community across Reddit has extremely positive brand sentiment which bolsters efficiency across paid media efforts.

With competitors also spending significantly across this platform, **our challenge was to find ways to stand out.** Our strategy was to capture attention and divert away from leading rivals, instead capturing a grassroots aspect that cannot be replicated by just running normal display ads

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A HIGHLY STRATEGIC APPROACH

THE BRIEF:

Acquire new users at scale, whilst remaining efficient in our Cost-Per-First-Deposit KPI.

THE CHALLENGE:

Due to stringent laws around advertising gambling products and services, typical audience expansion techniques are often constrained. Therefore, we continually proactively look for other ways to innovate with FanDuel in order to be able to gain new users in a very competitive market.

THE STRATEGY:

The target audience was 18–35-year-olds interested in sports and sports betting (specifically NFL). We ran specific state targeting, ensuring we only reached audiences in states online spots betting is legal.

The overall campaign ran across Apple Search Ads and Programmatic In-App Display. Within Reddit we ran display campaigns and tested 'Promoted User Posts'. This was a new ad format on Reddit, it was in 'alpha' at the time and therefore only available to select advertisers.

Due to our strong relationship with Reddit, we were were given the chance to test the new Promoted User Posts format for FanDuel.

A Kantar brand lift study was also conducted on the campaign which showed that Promoted User Posts helped to strengthen brand perceptions.

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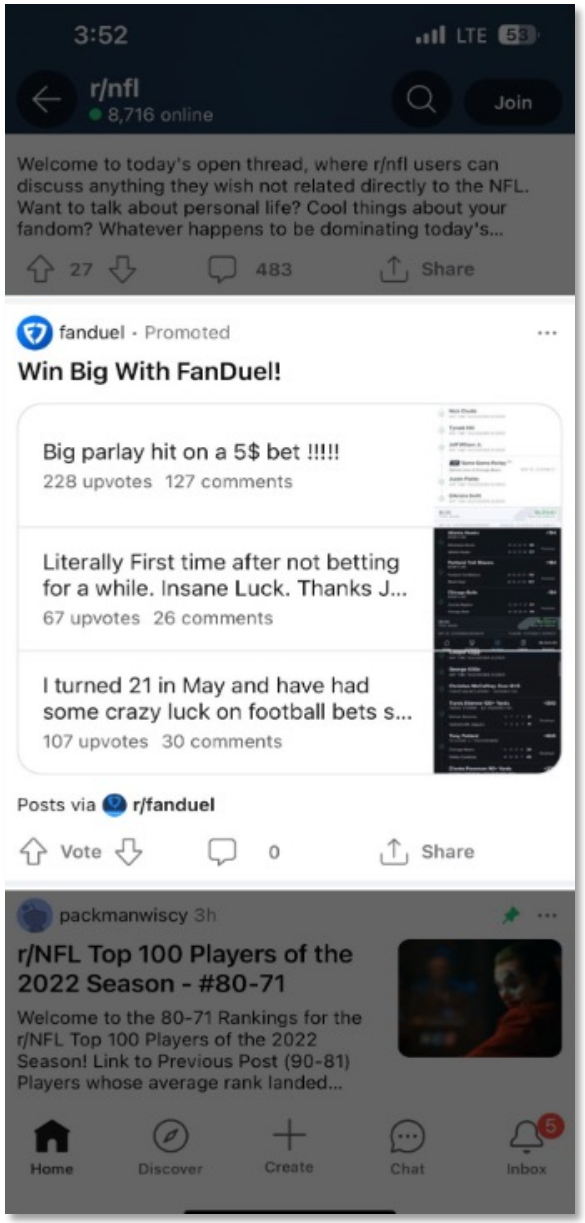
PROMOTED USER POSTS:

Promoted User Posts are a new ad format available on Reddit. Essentially, they let an advertiser identify an organic post that they find especially relevant to their brand or product and, with consent of the author promote the content.

HOW IT WORKS:

- A redditor creates a post with brand-relevant content
- A brand notices the post and contacts Reddit to ask if the post can be promoted
- Reddit contacts the author of the post to get explicit permission to use the post as a promotion.
- If permission is given, a promoted user post is created
- The original post will remain where it was originally uploaded. The promoted user post comment section will link to the original comments section.

The purpose is to use authentic content to further engage audiences of specific brands



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RESULTS

+381%

INCREASE IN INSTALLS

+418%

INCREASE IN FIRST TIME DEPOSITS

0.58%

CLICK THROUGH RATE

(INDUSTRY AVERAGE 0.2%)

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TALK TO US

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